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**Re: Fw: [EXTERNAL] Re: wow and thank you**

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**From** morgan <mckenney.morgan@gmail.com>

**Date** Fri 4/3/2026 6:44 PM

**To** Sevak, Amit <asevak@ets.org>

**Cc** Sinkfield, Rick <RSINKFIELD@ets.org>; Dusst, Email <EDUSST@ets.capital>; Allan Fisher <afisher.edu@gmail.com>; Sullivan, Cait <csullivan@ets.org>; Betaneli, Christine <cbetaneli@ets.org>; Harrison, Charles Kennon <kharrison@ets.org>

Wonderful news Amit and very exciting!  
Best, Morgan

On Fri, 3 Apr 2026 at 12:36, Sevak, Amit <asevak@ets.org> wrote:  
Just got Microsoft's endorsement! Google's coming soon....

Get [Outlook for iOS](#)

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**From:** Salman Khan <[sal@khanacademy.org](mailto:sal@khanacademy.org)>

**Sent:** Friday, April 3, 2026 3:33 PM

**To:** Jeana Jorgensen <[jeana.jorgensen@microsoft.com](mailto:jeana.jorgensen@microsoft.com)>

**Cc:** Lisa Thomas <[Lisa.Thomas@microsoft.com](mailto:Lisa.Thomas@microsoft.com)>; morgan <[mckenney.morgan@gmail.com](mailto:mckenney.morgan@gmail.com)>; Sevak, Amit <[asevak@ets.org](mailto:asevak@ets.org)>; Sarah Thaler <[sarahthaler@khanacademy.org](mailto:sarahthaler@khanacademy.org)>; Chris Anderson <[ca@ted.com](mailto:ca@ted.com)>; Logan McClure Davda <[davda@ted.com](mailto:davda@ted.com)>; Vicki Zubovic <[vicki@khanacademy.org](mailto:vicki@khanacademy.org)>; Naria Santa Lucia <[Naria.SantaLucia@microsoft.com](mailto:Naria.SantaLucia@microsoft.com)>; Renate Norman ((SHE/HER)) <[renallen@microsoft.com](mailto:renallen@microsoft.com)>

**Subject:** Re: [EXTERNAL] Re: wow and thank you

Thanks Jeana. This is great!

On Fri, Apr 3, 2026 at 12:26 PM Jeana Jorgensen <[jeana.jorgensen@microsoft.com](mailto:jeana.jorgensen@microsoft.com)> wrote:

Hi Sal –

Great to catch up earlier this week! I did the rounds within Microsoft to ensure alignment and all systems are a go on our end. We're so excited to partner with you on this joint skilling vision between Khan Academy and TED.

In the absence of a more formal MOU, since there is no exchanging of money between the companies, we just wanted to put a few things in writing to make sure we're both approaching this with the same understanding.

- Microsoft will partner in an advisory role to the Khan-TED Institute – this will not be branded Microsoft in any way; however, we will be listed as a core sponsor of this effort.
- Accreditation will be the responsibility of Khan-TED and not Microsoft or other partners.
- We are happy to provide a quote in support at the time of the announcement and would like the opportunity to review the press release and where Microsoft is mentioned prior to the announcement on April 14.

- There is no binding obligation to hire any graduates of the institute, but are excited to consider them alongside other worthy candidates for available jobs within Microsoft and share with our customer and partner ecosystem looking for candidates with AI capabilities.

We couldn't be more thrilled to partner with you. Assuming this is your shared hope and expectation as well, consider us committed to the cause alongside you!

LMK any next steps or support you need from us.

Thx,  
Jeana

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**From:** Jeana Jorgensen <[jeana.jorgensen@microsoft.com](mailto:jeana.jorgensen@microsoft.com)>

**Sent:** Thursday, March 26, 2026 6:57 PM

**To:** Salman Khan <[sal@khanacademy.org](mailto:sal@khanacademy.org)>

**Cc:** Lisa Thomas <[Lisa.Thomas@microsoft.com](mailto:Lisa.Thomas@microsoft.com)>; morgan <[mckenney.morgan@gmail.com](mailto:mckenney.morgan@gmail.com)>; Sevak, Amit <[asevak@ets.org](mailto:asevak@ets.org)>; Sarah Thaler <[sarahthaler@khanacademy.org](mailto:sarahthaler@khanacademy.org)>; Chris Anderson <[ca@ted.com](mailto:ca@ted.com)>; Logan McClure Davda <[davda@ted.com](mailto:davda@ted.com)>; Vicki Zubovic <[vicki@khanacademy.org](mailto:vicki@khanacademy.org)>

**Subject:** Re: [EXTERNAL] Re: wow and thank you

Thx so much for the quick response. Just getting out of my last meeting and your answers all sound great. Sorry I wasn't able to call today.

I've kicked off discussions with my HR and PR leaders to make sure all systems are a go on our side.

2 more questions:

- Would you want anything formal in place like an MOU or more of a verbal/email agreement given there is no funding involved?
- Do you have a specific event you are announcing this at or is this a virtual announcement via a social/press release and you are still trying to lock down the specific date on?

I will text you if any other questions come up and in the meantime, I'm circling the wagons over on our side. Exciting!

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**From:** Salman Khan <[sal@khanacademy.org](mailto:sal@khanacademy.org)>

**Sent:** Thursday, March 26, 2026 9:25:27 AM

**To:** Jeana Jorgensen <[jeana.jorgensen@microsoft.com](mailto:jeana.jorgensen@microsoft.com)>

**Cc:** Lisa Thomas <[Lisa.Thomas@microsoft.com](mailto:Lisa.Thomas@microsoft.com)>; morgan <[mckenney.morgan@gmail.com](mailto:mckenney.morgan@gmail.com)>; Sevak, Amit <[asevak@ets.org](mailto:asevak@ets.org)>; Sarah Thaler <[sarahthaler@khanacademy.org](mailto:sarahthaler@khanacademy.org)>; Chris Anderson <[ca@ted.com](mailto:ca@ted.com)>; Logan McClure Davda <[davda@ted.com](mailto:davda@ted.com)>; Vicki Zubovic <[vicki@khanacademy.org](mailto:vicki@khanacademy.org)>

**Subject:** Re: [EXTERNAL] Re: wow and thank you

Hi Jeana,

My responses are inline below:

On Wed, Mar 25, 2026 at 10:53 PM Jeana Jorgensen <[jeana.jorgensen@microsoft.com](mailto:jeana.jorgensen@microsoft.com)> wrote:

Hi Sal – so great to hear from you and terrific to hear of the progress you’ve made toward your vision we discussed earlier. Your timing always seems to be so incredibly on point as we’re deep in discussions on how best to address these issues you frame.

Short answer – yes – we’re very interested to learn more. I’m very much aligned to your vision outlined here. I would be interested in quickly exploring this more to get to a commitment in the tight timeframe before your announcement.

I read the doc below it sounds really interesting and of course is incredibly needed right now – especially when the media is instilling so much misguided fear in parents and their high school/college students that there will be no jobs for them because of AI. We are needing great early in career talent more than ever. I run the Early In Profession / university hiring for our commercial business and we are always looking for high quality candidates outside the traditional perspective of searching from the top X number of schools by whatever market criteria exists at the time. We also have a very deep need for AI skills in our broader partner ecosystem, so there is potentially a very ripe hiring pipeline.

To move the conversation forward – here are a couple of quick questions:

- In 2.5 weeks, are you announcing your intent to launch this with your stated launch partners and then work through the execution details post announcement?

Yes!

- The doc stated you are first targeting “a Bachelor of Science in Applied Artificial Intelligence, aimed at preparing students for AI-enabled knowledge work across fields like product, consulting, banking, and marketing”. When I think of a BS, I typically think of a more technical disciplines, but this mentions 3 non-technical disciplines (consulting, banking, marketing). Are building curriculum around technical skills for non-technical roles (marketers, consultants, etc) or are you building technical skills for technical roles (engineers, developers, admins, etc) in non-technical industries? This just makes a fairly big difference in the curriculum and skills for each one when you think about the hero learning pathways of teaching people how to **use** existing AI tools, how to **build** custom AI agents (and workflows), and how to **manage** disparate AI/agents (and workflows) as peers and employees or across environments. Either way – it’s all exciting! :)

I see this as developing folks who are optimally empowered in an AI age. So they’ll have an understanding of how AI works, but they won’t be AI researcher level. It is much more what you are talking about. They will learn to be builders, agent managers, workflow optimizers etc. I should make this clear in how we describe things.

- On #1 and 2 below – these are an easy yes for us. On #3, what does “a commitment” look like in your mind? I would love to run this as a first-run pilot within our commercial business organization to see how this would work broadly for the rest of Microsoft, but I wanted to get clarity on any specifics in your head in terms of volume of hires.

We intentionally left it a bit open right now. I am imagining that you would consider the top graduates of KTI on par with top graduates from anywhere. I think this will be compelling because the KTI students will have demonstrated mastery/competency of the skills that employers care about (especially because the employers will help co-design the activities/assessments) in a much more clear and transparent way than traditional college grads.

- We had talked before about verifying some of the more important human skills required in an eventual AI-dominated workplace – is that part of your potential curriculum too?

Yes! I think this is where this program will really shine. We are imagining a whole set of tasks/projects that involve students working with each other to create/analyze/simulate in groups and then review each other on the dimensions that we think matter most (e.g., collaboration, communication, entrepreneurial thinking, etc.). This will be roughly 1/3 of the program. Between large numbers of weighted peer review and AI assessment, we think we can create a strong signal for employers.

- Assuming you are multi-AI tool/model supportive in your approach? For Microsoft to recruit talent and promote to our customer/partner base, it's important that candidates know the fundamentals of AI (independent of tool) and then have an understanding of how to use Microsoft specific tools.

Yes. We'll want the students to have exposure to all major tools. Even more important will be building the meta skill of learning to use new tools fast/productively. One of the main values the employer partners add is codesigning real-world tasks using their tools.

Love that you are all pursuing this - if it's easier to talk through my questions this week or early next, happy to make time to jump on a call at any time.

I'm free after 2pm PST today if you'd like to chat further. My cell is 650-793-9474. Text me first so I know its you :)

Thx again for thinking of us – definitely interested,

Jeana

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**From:** Salman Khan <[sal@khanacademy.org](mailto:sal@khanacademy.org)>

**Sent:** Wednesday, March 25, 2026 9:05 PM

**To:** Jeana Jorgensen <[jeana.jorgensen@microsoft.com](mailto:jeana.jorgensen@microsoft.com)>; Lisa Thomas <[Lisa.Thomas@microsoft.com](mailto:Lisa.Thomas@microsoft.com)>  
**Cc:** morgan <[mckenney.morgan@gmail.com](mailto:mckenney.morgan@gmail.com)>; Sevak, Amit <[asevak@ets.org](mailto:asevak@ets.org)>; Sarah Thaler <[sarahthaler@khanacademy.org](mailto:sarahthaler@khanacademy.org)>; Chris Anderson <[ca@ted.com](mailto:ca@ted.com)>; Logan McClure Davda <[davda@ted.com](mailto:davda@ted.com)>; Vicki Zubovic <[vicki@khanacademy.org](mailto:vicki@khanacademy.org)>  
**Subject:** [EXTERNAL] Re: wow and thank you

Hi Jeana and Lisa,

I hope all is well!

We've continued to make progress on the new higher education institution we envisioned with you last year. We hope to announce it in 2.5 weeks at TED (where I am now also the Vision Steward). I wanted to see if Microsoft is up for being one of the named partners at launch.

At a high level, we are building what we are calling the Khan TED Institute to help address a growing gap in higher education and workforce preparation. Traditional degrees are becoming harder to justify on cost, while many lower-cost alternatives do not yet provide the rigor, signal, or community that students and employers are looking for. Our aim is to create a high-quality, low-cost undergraduate experience that is relevant to a rapidly changing world, especially one being reshaped by AI.

The Institute is being developed in partnership with Khan Academy, TED, and ETS. The vision is to combine mastery-based learning, strong communication and collaboration, hands-on work using modern AI tools, and close alignment with what leading employers actually value. We believe there is an opportunity to create something that is both much more accessible and much more relevant than the traditional model.

We are not asking for funding. Partnering involves roughly three things:

1. Being named as an early corporate partner in the announcement and/or on the website
2. Working with us to help refine some of the simulations and projects so they produce a signal that companies like Microsoft would actually care about
3. A commitment to taking graduates seriously for internships and recruiting, assuming they demonstrate the level of ability the program is designed to surface

We expect this to be a modest commitment, but we think Microsoft's perspective would be especially valuable given the company's leadership in AI, productivity, cloud infrastructure, and the future of work more broadly. Done well, I think this could give you a robust talent pipeline. I also think that it is powerful for major tech organizations to be part of the solution for training the workforce of the future.

[More on it here.](#)

Regards,

Sal

On Thu, Sep 18, 2025 at 9:32 AM Jeana Jorgensen <[jeana.jorgensen@microsoft.com](mailto:jeana.jorgensen@microsoft.com)> wrote:

Hi Sal – thank you so much on several fronts:

1. We very much appreciated you taking the time to come talk with us. I know you have a ton of momentum and excitement that is occupying your time, but it meant so much for us to hear from someone in our space with such a common mission and set of values.
2. You absolutely crushed it – every conversation I had yesterday with people around the team said you were their favorite guest speaker we've ever had and were riveted with your stories and insights. This is not to flatter you, but to say that your purpose was so clearly evident and people felt how your genuine passion and humility led to such incredible success.
3. And finally – I was so personally excited to talk to you about the potential of working together. I've thought so much about how our values around education and creating opportunity for others could lead to some pretty remarkable things.

I would love the chance to follow up on our conversation before your keynote, so if you are up for it, I'm happy to get that scheduled. Microsoft is the smallest big company – I know we may seem daunting to navigate, but it's really very small in many ways and I'd be happy to help be the conduit to working more closely with you and the rest of your efforts and organizations you represent.

You were the clear highlight of the entire event and that says a lot because this team knows how to have fun. 😊

Thx again,

Jeana

Jeana Jorgensen

Corp Vice President, Worldwide Learning

Microsoft

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